

Chapter 106-2

After a moment, Liang Wanwan said in a low voice: "It's Chen Mian, the one who loves painting."

As soon as this brief introduction came out, a figure emerged in Liang Shi's mind.

The girl wasn't strikingly beautiful. She had a mole under her eye, very long eyelashes, and abnormally pale skin. She rarely got sun exposure, as if she were a nocturnal creature—she always carried an umbrella when going out. She often sat in the art studio for hours at a time, and once she picked up a brush, she wouldn't put it down.

She was a very quiet person.

Especially the melancholic aura about her—it was many times heavier than Liang Wanwan's.

Just by standing there, you would feel she was either an unappreciated talent or someone plagued by misfortune.

The name Chen Mian also suited her perfectly.

Liang Shi initially couldn't dig this person out of her memories, simply because the name wasn't memorable, and the original host hadn't had much interaction with her.

And these were all very distant memories.

This was just someone the original host had met while learning to paint in middle school. They could only be called art studio classmates—they had studied together for two years but barely exchanged a few words.

However, Chen Mian had once approached her on her own initiative back then, saying only two things.

One was: "So you're Liang Shi."

The other was: "Nothing special."

It seemed like a provocation.

For the original host at that time, of course she threw a punch.

But unexpectedly, Chen Mian, who looked so sickly and weak that she had no fighting ability whatsoever, actually caught the original host's fist with her bare hand. Then she curved her lips into a slight sneer and turned to walk away.

This was the only interaction they had during their student days.

But Chen Mian later became famous.

Liang Wanwan really liked her painting style, so she mustered up the courage to ask Liang Shi to get Chen Mian's autograph.

This was one of the rare times Liang Wanwan asked the original host for anything.

After hearing this request, Liang Shi hesitated for a moment and asked: "Can't you just buy one?"

"Jie, you can't buy one," Liang Wanwan said. "Chen Mian almost never gives autographs. She only paints."

The original host, being wealthy and generous: "Then buy her paintings."

"Can't buy those either," Liang Wanwan said. "Her paintings are only displayed at exhibitions. She never allows private collections."

Looking at Liang Wanwan's eager eyes, the original host finally compromised: "I can only try asking for you. I can't guarantee it'll work."

Even with just this promise, Liang Wanwan was very happy.

The original host hadn't contacted Chen Mian for a very long time by then, but she had added all kinds of people to her account. So from her account with nearly a thousand contacts, she found Chen Mian's WeChat.

The WeChat profile picture was a moon—a very dim moon. The composition wasn't particularly remarkable either.

The original host, who was never good at asking others for favors, sat there thinking about her wording for half an hour, figuring out how to bring this up with Chen Mian.

After much deliberation, she just sent a cocky voice message: "Chen Mian, is this you?"

The original host said: "My painting skills are 'nothing special,' but you're so amazing. Can you give me an autograph?"

Chen Mian quickly replied: [Liang Shi?]

The original host responded with an "mm" and also told her: "I can pay you too."

After a long while, Chen Mian said: [Let's meet.]

Then she gave an address and time.

The original host brought Liang Wanwan along. The day they met Chen Mian was still bright and sunny, but Chen Mian had brought a black umbrella. When she closed the umbrella handle, the black contrasted sharply with her almost sickly pale skin—quite eye-catching.

She was still the same as many years ago, unchanged.

Liang Wanwan sat next to the original host, her eyes full of anticipation.

The original host first cleared herself of any misunderstanding: "It's my younger sister who really likes you. I haven't painted for many years."

Chen Mian laughed lightly, her voice cool and detached: "I never said you liked me."

Chen Mian asked her: "Have you been doing well these years?"

It was just like old friends catching up, but the original host had no old times to catch up on with her.

They weren't the kind of relationship where they could exchange pleasantries upon meeting.

They had barely interacted during their student days, so meeting now left the original host puzzled.

But this person had always been an oddball. The original host didn't think too much about it, gave a perfunctory response, and then had Liang Wanwan take out the paper she had prepared, wanting Chen Mian to sign it.

But Chen Mian didn't sign. She still insisted on her viewpoint: "A painter's brush is for painting, not for signing autographs."

So Chen Mian drew over twenty pictures on sticky notes for Liang Wanwan.

They were simple sketches.

There was also one piece that was Chen Mian's earliest work—that moon painting. She said she wanted to give it to Liang Shi.

And she required that Liang Shi not give it away to anyone else.

The original host didn't think much of it at the time. She accepted the painting that she couldn't make heads or tails of and casually agreed to Chen Mian's request.

But after returning home, she directly gave it to Liang Wanwan.

Liang Wanwan didn't even dare accept it, feeling it was her idol's heartfelt work and had been specifically meant for her to keep. But the original host said: "I don't have any art appreciation ability right now. If this thing stays with me, it'll just end up getting burned."

Liang Wanwan treasured that painting at home, while she carried the sketchbook with her at all times.